

HIGHER SECONDARY SECOND YEAR (H.S. 2nd Year)
POLITICAL SCIENCE – 2019 (Code: 29T POSC)
Solved Question Paper (Guide)

Full Marks: 100 | Time: 3 Hours

Note: As this is a guide, all questions are solved, including every 'OR' / 'Any ____' question.

Note: Page 6 of your 2019 paper (Q.20 to Q.27) was not in the file you sent, so those questions are not solved here. Send that page and I will add them.

PART – A : Contemporary World Politics

Q.1 (1 mark each)

Q.1(a) Write the full form of SEATO.

Ans:

South East Asia Treaty Organisation (formed 1954).

Q.1(b) The collapse of which country is known as the collapse of 'Second World'?

Ans:

The Soviet Union (USSR), 1991.

Q.1(c) First Gulf War is also known as Operation Desert Storm. (Yes/No)

Ans:

Yes.

Q.1(d) Agra Summit: name of the Indian Prime Minister who participated.

Ans:

Atal Bihari Vajpayee (Agra Summit, 2001, with Pakistan's President Pervez Musharraf).

Q.1(e) Rio Summit approved a developmental programme named 'Agenda-21'. (Yes/No)

Ans:

Yes (1992).

Q.1(f) World Council of Indigenous People was formed in 1974/1975/1976.

Ans:

1975.

Q.2 – 7 (2 marks each)

Q.2 Mention two reforms Mikhail Gorbachev initiated in the Soviet Union.

Ans:

Mikhail Gorbachev (leader from 1985) introduced two reforms in the Soviet Union:

- Perestroika: economic restructuring, giving freedom to enterprises and reducing central control.
- Glasnost: openness, i.e., freedom of speech, press and political liberalisation.

Q.3 Mention two areas of conflict between India and Bangladesh.

Ans:

- Sharing of river waters (Ganga/Farakka and Teesta water disputes).
- Illegal migration and border problems (border fencing, smuggling, border killings).

Q.4 Write the name of two conflicting communities of Sri Lanka.

Ans:

The two conflicting communities of Sri Lanka are the Sinhalese (majority) and the Tamils (minority).

Q.5 Write the name of two NGOs concerned with Protection of Human Rights all over the world.

Ans:

- Amnesty International
- Human Rights Watch

Q.6 Write two distinctions between migrants and refugees.

Ans:

- Migrants leave their country voluntarily, mainly for better jobs, education or living conditions; refugees are forced to flee due to war, persecution, violence or natural disaster.
- Migrants can return home and still enjoy the protection of their own government; refugees cannot return safely and need international protection (e.g., UNHCR).

Q.7 In which year was Kyoto Protocol signed? The Protocol dealt with which problem of the environment?

Ans:

The Kyoto Protocol was signed in 1997 (at Kyoto, Japan). It dealt with the problem of global warming: it set binding targets for industrialised countries to reduce emissions of greenhouse gases like carbon dioxide.

Q.8 – 12 (4 marks each)

Q.8 Discuss briefly about the new International Economic Order.

Ans:

The NIEO was demanded by developing (Third World) countries at UNCTAD in 1972 to correct the unfair international economic system. Its goals were:

- Control over natural resources: developing countries should control their own resources.
- Access to Western markets so that they can sell their goods and get fair prices for raw materials.
- Reduction of the cost of Western technology and more technology transfer.
- A greater role in international economic institutions such as the IMF and World Bank, and relief from debt.

The developed countries did not fully accept these demands.

Q.9 What 9/11 indicates in world politics? Discuss briefly.

Ans:

9/11 refers to the terrorist attacks of 11 September 2001 on the World Trade Center (New York) and the Pentagon (Washington) in the USA, by hijackers of Al-Qaeda. It indicates:

- Terrorism has become a major global threat and even the most powerful country is vulnerable.
- The USA launched the 'war on terror': attack on Afghanistan (2001) and Iraq (2003), showing American hegemony and unilateralism.
- Nations began to cooperate against terrorism, and security concerns changed; it also raised debates on human rights and Islamophobia.

Q.10 Discuss briefly the functions of the World Bank.

Ans:

The World Bank (IBRD) was set up in 1944 at the Bretton Woods Conference. Its functions are:

- To give long-term loans to member countries for reconstruction and development projects (roads, dams, power, schools, health).
- To provide technical advice and expertise to developing countries.
- To reduce poverty and promote economic growth and social development.
- To encourage foreign private investment and balanced growth of international trade.

Q.11 Discuss briefly about the components of the Security Strategy of India.

Ans:

India's security strategy has four main components:

- Strengthening military capacity: because of threats from neighbours; India tested nuclear weapons in 1974 and 1998 for deterrence.
- Strengthening international norms and institutions: support for the UN, disarmament and the Non-Aligned Movement.
- Meeting internal security challenges: dealing with insurgency in Nagaland, Mizoram, Kashmir and the North-East.
- Developing the economy: removing poverty and inequality to ensure national security.

Q.12 Discuss about the cultural consequences of globalization.

Ans:

Globalisation has strong cultural effects:

- Spread of a common (mostly Western) culture in food, dress, music and films; called 'cultural homogenisation' or 'McDonaldisation'.
- Threat to local and traditional cultures, languages and customs, especially in developing countries.
- At the same time, cultural exchange and 'cultural hybridisation' take place (e.g., Indian yoga, cuisine and Bollywood spreading in the world; 'Indian jeans-kurta' fusion).
- Culture can also be a source of identity assertion, so people protect their local culture.

Q.13 – 14 (6 marks each)

Q.13 Why did Soviet Union disintegrate? Discuss elaborately.

Ans:

The USSR disintegrated in December 1991. The main causes were:

- Economic stagnation: the planned economy was inefficient; shortage of consumer goods and heavy military spending.
- Political weakness: the Communist Party was authoritarian and corrupt, with no real democracy or freedom.
- Rise of nationalism in the republics (Baltic states, Ukraine, Georgia) demanding independence.
- Gorbachev's reforms (Glasnost and Perestroika) and the Afghan war/arms race weakened the system, and the fall of the Berlin Wall (1989) hastened the collapse.

[OR] Q.13 Discuss elaborately the U.S. hegemony as an Economic Super Power.

Ans:

The USA is the world's greatest economic superpower:

- Its economy is the largest in the world, accounting for about a quarter of world GDP; the dollar is the main reserve currency and used in most trade.
- After the Second World War it created the Bretton Woods system: the IMF, World Bank and later GATT/WTO, which it controls through its voting power; and the Marshall Plan rebuilt Europe.
- Its MNCs (Apple, Microsoft, Google, Amazon, Coca-Cola) and technology and universities dominate the world.
- It can use sanctions and the dollar financial system as tools of power.
- Challenges to this hegemony: China's rise, the 2008 financial crisis, huge debt and the move toward 'de-dollarisation'.

Q.14 What are the main pillars of ASEAN? Discuss elaborately.

Ans:

ASEAN (Association of Southeast Asian Nations) was established on 8 August 1967 by the Bangkok Declaration with five members (Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand); now it has ten members. Its motto is 'One Vision, One Identity, One Community'. Its Secretariat is at Jakarta. Its three pillars are:

1. ASEAN Security Community (ASC):

It aims at peaceful settlement of disputes and regional peace; the ASEAN Regional Forum (1994) and the Treaty of Amity and Cooperation (1976) work for this; non-interference is a basic principle.

2. ASEAN Economic Community (AEC):

It aims at a single market and production base, free flow of goods, services and investment, and reducing the development gap; the ASEAN Free Trade Area (AFTA) is part of it, along with trade pacts with India, China and others.

3. ASEAN Socio-Cultural Community (ASCC):

It aims at cooperation in education, culture, health, environment and social development, to create a common ASEAN identity.

[OR] Q.14 Discuss the rise of China as an Economic Power.

Ans:

China's rise as an economic power:

- After the Communist revolution (1949), China was poor; in 1978 Deng Xiaoping introduced economic reforms and the 'Open Door Policy', allowing foreign investment, Special Economic Zones (SEZs) and markets.
- The economy grew at about 9–10% a year for decades; China became the 'factory of the world' and the second-largest economy (after the USA), and the biggest exporter.
- Joined the WTO in 2001; built huge foreign exchange reserves and invests abroad through the Belt and Road Initiative (BRI).
- It has also made progress in technology, infrastructure and removed hundreds of millions from poverty.
- Challenges: inequality, environment damage, ageing population and trade disputes with the USA.

PART – B : Politics in India Since Independence

Q.15 (1 mark each)

Q.15(a) Write the full form of N.D.A.

Ans:

National Democratic Alliance.

Q.15(b) Party that won the second largest number of Lok Sabha seats in the First General Election of India.

Ans:

Communist Party of India (CPI) – 16 seats.

Q.15(c) In which year Election Commission started using E.V.M?

Ans:

1982 (first used experimentally in the Paravur by-election, Kerala); used fully all over India from 2004.

Q.15(d) Prime Minister of the coalition government of 1989?

Ans:

V.P. Singh (National Front government).

Q.15(e) The Government of India appointed Mandal Commission in the year ____.

Ans:

1979.

Q.15(f) Write one feature of New Economic Policy of India.

Ans:

Liberalisation (removal of licences and controls on industry and trade); also privatisation and globalisation.

Q.16 – 19 (2 marks each)

Q.16 When was Bharatiya Jana Sangh formed? Who was the founder President?

Ans:

The Bharatiya Jana Sangh was formed in 1951; its founder President was Syama Prasad Mukherjee.

Q.17 On which date was the draft of the Indian Constitution signed and when did it come into force?

Ans:

The draft of the Constitution was signed and adopted by the Constituent Assembly on 26 November 1949, and it came into force on 26 January 1950 (Republic Day).

Q.18 Write two reasons responsible for growing importance of regional political parties in Indian politics.

Ans:

- Growth of regional identity (language, culture) and neglect of regions by the Centre.
- Decline of the Congress and the coalition era after 1989, which gave regional parties a bargaining role.

Q.19 Which two union territories were given the status of statehood in 1972?

Ans:

Manipur and Tripura (Meghalaya also became a full state in 1972).

Q.28 (6 marks)

Q.28 Discuss the consequences of National Emergency declared on 25th June, 1975.

Ans:

The Emergency was declared on 25 June 1975 by Indira Gandhi under Article 352 on the ground of 'internal disturbance'. Its consequences were:

- Fundamental rights were suspended, press censorship was imposed, and thousands of opposition leaders (J.P. Narayan, Morarji Desai, etc.) were arrested under MISA.
- Parliament extended its term and passed the 42nd Amendment (1976) giving more powers to the Centre; elections were postponed.
- Forced sterilisation and slum clearance (Sanjay Gandhi's Five-Point Programme) caused public anger.
- In the 1977 election the Congress was defeated and the Janata Party came to power, the 44th Amendment (1978) made it difficult to misuse emergency powers.
- Lessons: democracy is strong in India and cannot be ignored; the judiciary and press gained importance.

[OR] Q.28 Discuss elaborately about the Secessionist Movements of North-East India.

Ans:

Secessionist movements in North-East India demanded separation from India or great autonomy:

- Nagaland: The Naga National Council under A.Z. Phizo demanded independence from 1950s; armed rebellion followed; Nagaland became a state in 1963; the NSCN continues the demand for 'Greater Nagalim'.
- Mizoram: The Mizo National Front (MNF) led by Laldenga started a revolt in 1966 after the 1959 famine; the Mizoram Accord (1986) ended it and Mizoram became a state in 1987.
- Assam: the Assam Movement (1979–85) against illegal immigrants ended with the Assam Accord (1985); the ULFA demanded a sovereign Assam, and later Bodo, Karbi and other groups demanded separate states/autonomy.
- Manipur, Tripura and Meghalaya also saw insurgency by groups like the PLA and NLFT, and these were met by the government through the use of force (AFSPA), peace talks and creation of new states and autonomous councils.

The government's policy has been a mix of dialogue, accords, development and security measures.